

Bazaar



We test the latest and the best hardware and software products available in the market

Intel Pentium 4 2.53 GHz

Speed demon

If you crave for nothing but the best, then this processor is for you. This speed demon demolished every benchmark we threw at it. It runs at a super-fast speed of 2.53 GHz, screaming along at a quad-pumped FSB of 533 MHz. This P4 is based on the Northwood core—thus featuring 512 KB of full speed L2 cache, resulting in faster gameplay and multimedia. It zoomed past all our previous records and screamed into our hall of fame as the first one to shatter the 400 fps barrier in the normal quality mode in *Quake III*.

It also scored a massive 115.8 in Content Creation Winstone 2001 and scored an equally impressive 106.2 in Business Winstone 2001.

Price: Rs 38,220
Contact: Nebula Technologies
Phone: 022-6730567
Fax: 022-6730566
E-mail: pradip@nebulatech.com
Web site: www.intel.com



To put things in perspective, a Celeron 400 would score only 19.3 in Content Creation and 17.7 in Business Winstone 2001.

Its ability to crunch numbers depends on the system bandwidth, which can only be satisfied by an RDRAM-based board and a top-of-the-line graphics card. This processor is recommended only for users with stout hearts and deep pockets.

SPECIFICATIONS

Pentium 4 2.53 GHz, 512 KB of L2 cache, SSE2, 533 MHz FSB, 0.13 micron fabrication

Intel Pentium 4 2.53 GHz B+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Philips Fisio 820 cell phone

Small, sleek and ready for the future

The Philips Fisio 820 sports a contoured body, weighing only 85 grams and features a colour display screen (256 colour, 120x130 pixels with 9 lines). You can adjust different settings such as contrast and back-



light. It features an e-mail client with picture attachments, along with voice dial and voice memo. It also supports WAP 1.21, Bluetooth and GPRS.

It lets you store up to 500 numbers in the phone book, 10 dialled calls, 10

received calls and 10 missed calls. Through the menu you can change wallpapers, screensavers or screen themes according to your choice. It also has a feature called quick settings, through which pre-defined settings such as car, silent and meeting can be quickly applied. The buttons of the phone are quite well placed but they feel a bit tacky and need some getting used to. However, the voice reception, both inside and out-

Price: Rs 21,995
Contact: Philips India Ltd
Phone: 011-3731046
E-mail: rishi.goyal@philips.com
Web site: www.philips.com

doors was disappointing. Strangely, the handset that we received would switch off whenever we tried to read an SMS message. All in all, a very expensive phone for the performance it offers.

SPECIFICATIONS

Dual band (GSM 900/1800), 256-colour display, 5 hours 30 minute talk time, 1.21 WAP-browser, GPRS-enabled
Dimension: 98x47x21 mm, 85 gm

Philips Fisio 820 B	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

SoftWriting CharacTell 3.2

ICR this!

ICR software goes a step beyond OCR—it not only recognises print characters, but also handwriting and converts them into editable documents. During our tests with SoftWriting CharacTell 3.2 using simple handwriting samples (the characters were separated from each other and capitalised) it showed an accuracy of 96.97 per cent. But the software still has a long way to go to make it useful as its accuracy for recognising running handwriting is not so reliable as we discovered



when we tested the software with freestyle handwriting—its accuracy dropped down to a lowly 10 per cent! On a positive note, the product can learn as it is used more often—this is a time-consuming task, worth its while if you want the software to operate with reasonable accuracy.

SPECIFICATIONS

Supported languages: English, Spanish and German
System Requirements: Windows 95/98/Me/2000/NT 4.0, Intel 486 or faster processor, 20 MB disk space, 32 MB RAM

Price: Rs 9,980
Contact: Questa Software Systems Pvt. Ltd "Netspider"
Phone: 022-8633514
E-mail: sales@netspiderindia.com
Web site: www.netspiderindia.com

SoftWriting CharacTell B	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶